

Customer Review Analysis

*First Year Under New
Management*

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Touch of East

Introduction:

Touch of East is a beauty and wellness business, encompassing traditional and modern techniques to provide customers with high-quality services, such as threading, waxing, facials, nails and massages. Following a change in management and ownership, the business has just celebrated its first anniversary under the new owners. The customer review analysis aims to evaluate the feedback received under the new management, to see how well the customers feel under the new management and highlight the strengths and weaknesses of the business.

Methodology:

The data was collected from Google reviews published by customers after their treatments and appointments. The reviews cover the period from August 2024, when the business went under new management, until August 2025. There was a total of 101 reviews under this period; after removing empty reviews (NA), the dataset was reduced to 87 reviews.

This analysis was performed using Python. The NLTK library was used to tokenise the review text, remove stopwords and punctuation, and focus the analysis on meaningful words. Additional business-specific words were also removed using a custom stopwords list. Stemming was then applied to reduce words to their root form.

Following the pre-processing, sentiment analysis was performed to classify whether each review was positive or negative. This allowed for a quantitative assessment of the customer satisfaction during the first year of new management. The TextBlob library was used to calculate polarity scores, which were then used to classify each review as positive or negative.

Analysis & Results:

Sentiment Distribution:

Out of the 87 reviews analysed, the majority expressed positive sentiment. Approximately 96.6% (84) of the reviews were classified as positive, while the other 3.4% (3) was classified as negative (Figure 1). This suggests that the overall customer satisfaction during the first year was extremely high, and only limited areas for improvement were identified from the review data.

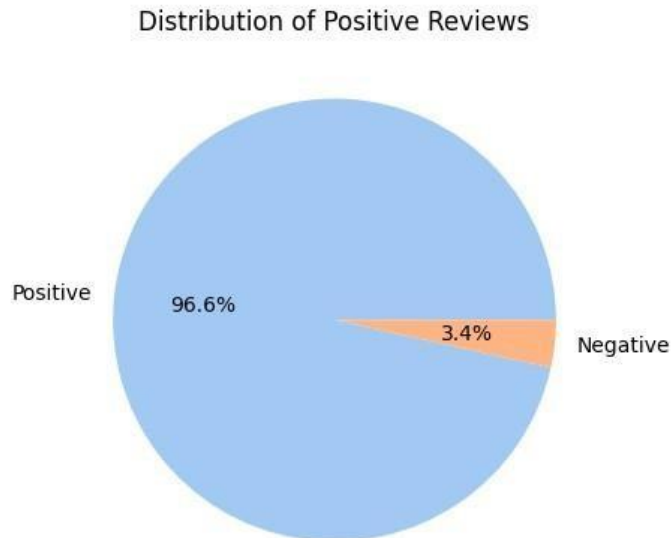


Figure 1 : Distribution of Positive & Negative Customer Reviews

Average Ratings:

The average star rating across all reviews was 4.85 out of 5. This highlights that the majority of the customers were satisfied with their experience, with only a small number of low ratings slightly reducing the average down. (Figure 2)

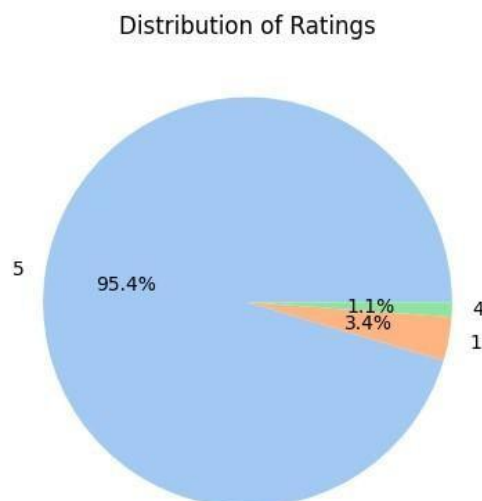


Figure 2: The Distribution of the star ratings across reviews

As shown above, most customers awarded Touch of East the highest rating of 5 Stars, with a small proportion giving 1 star. Only a very small number of reviews were rated at 4 stars. The distribution indicates that most customers had a highly positive experience under new management, with only a few low ratings, highlighting little areas of improvement.

Ratings & Polarity Analysis:

The initial analysis showed there was no strong correlation between the polarity scores and customer ratings (Figure 3 & Figure 4), suggesting that though the customers may have used positive or negative language within their ratings, they did not align consistently. a combined satisfaction score was created by normalising the star rating and combining it with the TextBlob polarity score, was used to address this issue. This provided a broader customer satisfaction indicator by considering both written feedback and numerical ratings.

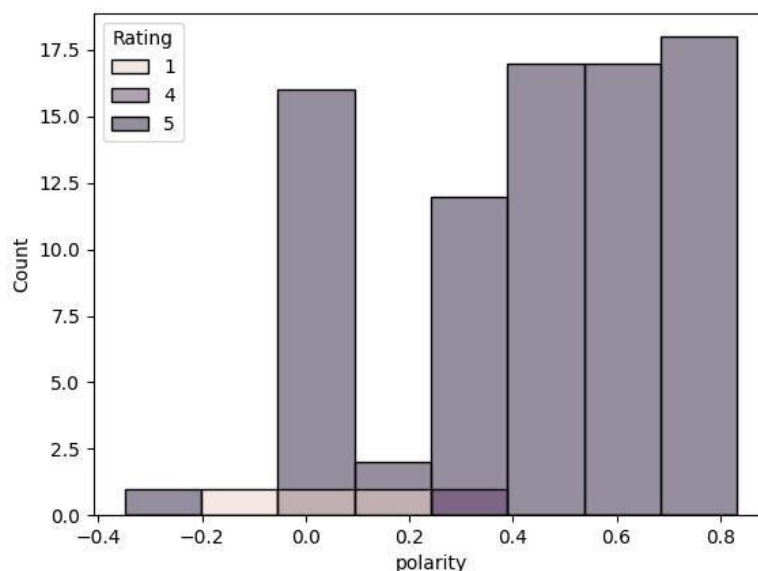


Figure 3: Histogram of original polarity scores and Star ratings

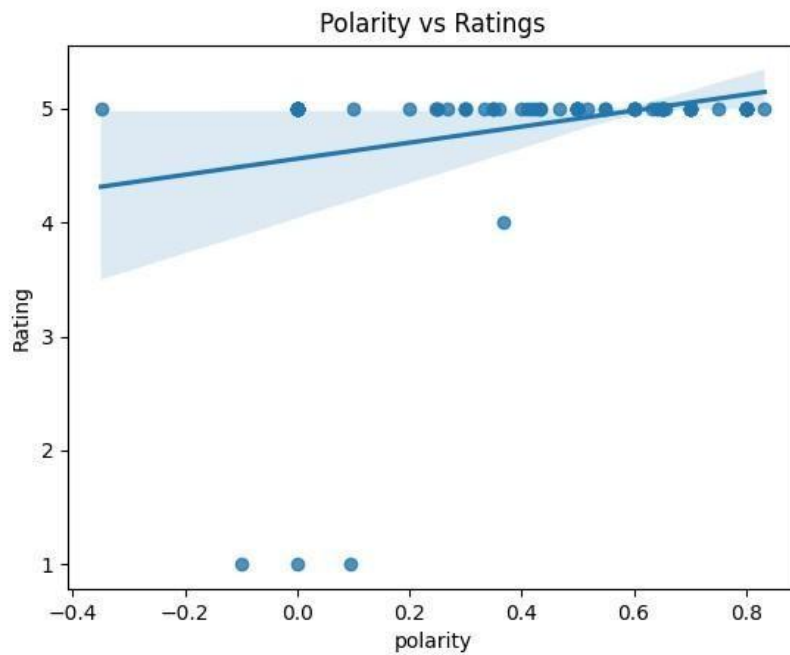


Figure 4: Scatter Plot of polarity scores VS Star rating (showing a weaker correlation)

As shown in Figure 3 and 4, the polarity scores are widely dispersed and do not consistently align with the customer star ratings. Thus, suggesting the sentiment does not reliably reflect overall customer satisfaction.

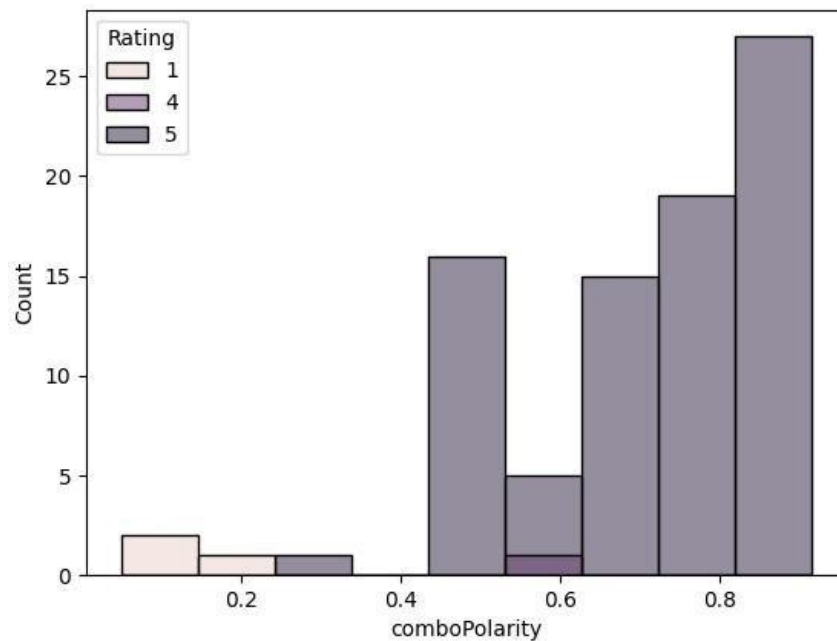


Figure 5: Histogram of Combined Polarity and Rating

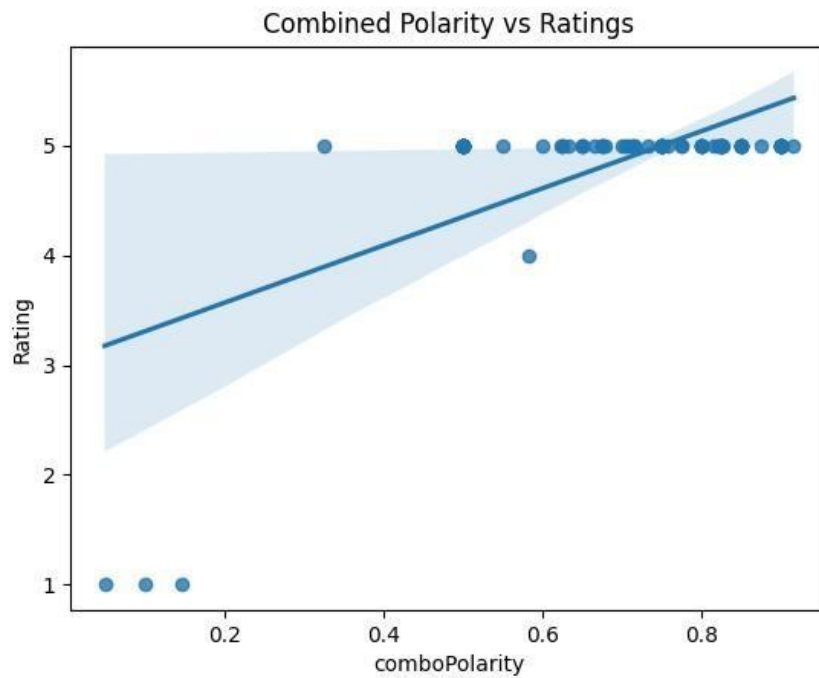


Figure 6: Scatter plot of the Combined Polarity VS Star Ratings (Showing a Stronger Correlation)

As shown in Figure 5 & 6, the combined polarity is more closely grouped together, still with a few outliers. The combined satisfaction score shows a clearer relationship with customer ratings because it includes both numerical ratings and written review sentiment. This provides a broader view of customer satisfaction than polarity alone.

Positive Review Analysis:

The word cloud in Figure 7 shows the most frequent words used in positive reviews. Most frequent words include “friendly”, “love”, “staff”, and “great”. Notably, “staff” appeared in 100% of the reviews, while “friendly” around 91% of the reviews. This highlights that the customers consistently praised the team, suggesting they felt welcomed and valued while getting their treatments. The reviews emphasise the strong communication skills, professionalism, and high-quality service.



Figure 7: Word Cloud of the Top 10 words in the Positive Reviews

The top 10 positive words reinforce the fact the clients and customers of the business, rate the professionalism and care of the staff under the new management.

Negative Reviews Analysis:

Due to the small number of negative reviews, these findings should be treated as isolated examples rather than strong recurring trends. The most frequent words included “never”, “return”, and “rush”, suggesting that the negative comments were linked to individual service experiences.



Figure 8: Word Cloud of the Top 10 words in the Negative Reviews

Limitations:

This analysis is based on a relatively small dataset of 87 usable Google Reviews, so the results may not represent every customer experience. Google Reviews may also be biased towards customers who had particularly positive or negative experiences. In addition, TextBlob is a simple rule-based sentiment tool and may not fully understand sarcasm, context, or beauty-service-specific language. Future work could compare results with VADER or transformer-based sentiment models and include a larger dataset over multiple years.

Conclusion:

The customer review analysis for Touch of East during its first year under new management showed a very high level of customer satisfaction. Out of 87 analysed reviews, 84 were classified as positive, giving a positive sentiment rate of 96.6%. The average customer rating was also high at 4.85 out of 5.

The analysis showed that customers frequently praised the staff, friendliness, and quality of service. Negative feedback was limited to a small number of isolated reviews, meaning there was no strong evidence of a recurring service issue.

Overall, the findings suggest that Touch of East has built strong customer satisfaction under the new management. However, due to the small dataset and limitations of TextBlob sentiment analysis, the results should be interpreted as an initial customer feedback analysis rather than a complete measure of business performance.